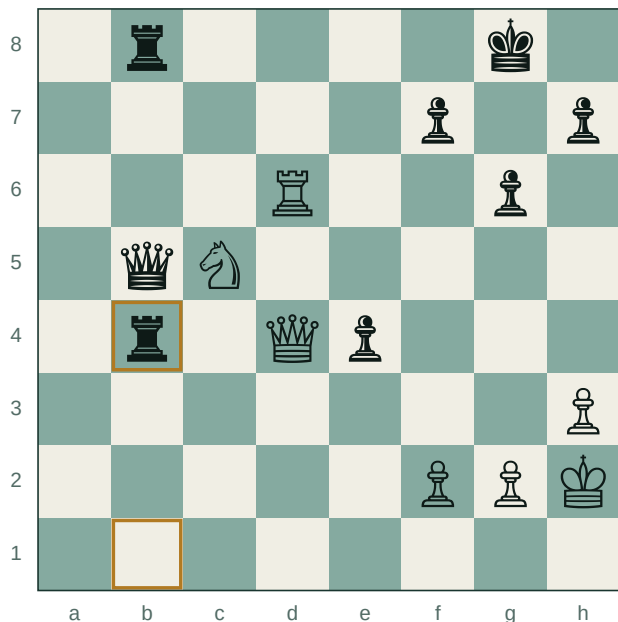


Active defensive resources: White, move 36

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 35...Rb4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36. Rd8+ Rxd8 37. Qxd8+ Kg7 38. Nd7

36.Rd8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From d8 it attacks king on g8 and rook on b8. Recorded reply: **36...Rxd8**.

37.Qxd8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on d8. Recorded reply: **37...Kg7**.

38.Nd7 The knight moves from c5 to d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -3 to -3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.